CAMBRIDGE

IELTS Academic 21

剑桥雅思官方真题集 学术类

Authentic Practice Tests

Produced by Cambridge University Press & Assessment

剑桥大学出版社与考试委员会 编著

- With Audio
- With Answers
- With Resource Bank

群言出版社
QUNYAN PRESS

CAMBRIDGE

IELTS

Academic 21

剑桥雅思官方真题集 学术类

Authentic Practice Tests

Produced by Cambridge University Press & Assessment

剑桥大学出版社与考试委员会 编著

群言出版社
QUNYAN PRESS
·北京·

图书在版编目（CIP）数据

剑桥雅思官方真题集. 21. 学术类 / 英国剑桥大学出版社与考试委员会编著. -- 北京 : 群言出版社, 2026. 6. -- ISBN 978-7-5193-1205-3

Ⅰ. H310.41-44

中国国家版本馆 CIP 数据核字第 2026DX1145 号

版权登记：图字 01—2026—1704号

This is a reprint of the following title published by Cambridge University Press & Assessment:

Cambridge IELTS 21 (Academic) (ISBN: 9781009826723)

Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2026

This reprint for the People's Republic of China (excluding Hong Kong, Macau and Taiwan) is published by arrangement with the Press Syndicate of the University of Cambridge, Cambridge, United Kingdom.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment and Qunyan Press 2026.

This reprint is authorized for sale in the People's Republic of China (excluding Hong Kong, Macau and Taiwan) only.

Unauthorized export of this reprint is a violation of the Copyright Act. No part of this publication may be reproduced or distributed by any means, or stored in a database or retrieval system, without the prior written permission of Cambridge University Press & Assessment and Qunyan Press.

此版本仅限在中华人民共和国境内（不包括中国香港、澳门特别行政区及中国台湾地区）销售。未经授权出口此版本属违法行为。未经剑桥大学出版社与考试委员会和群言出版社书面同意，本书任何部分不得以任何方式被翻印或传播，不得载入数据或检索系统。

责任编辑：刘　波
封面设计：李　倩

出版发行：群言出版社
地　　址：北京市东城区东厂胡同北巷1号（100006）
网　　址：www.qypublish.com（官网书城）
电子信箱：dywh@xdf.cn　qunyancbs@126.com
联系电话：010-62418641　65267783　65263836
法律顾问：北京法政安邦律师事务所
经　　销：全国新华书店

印　　刷：北京华联印刷有限公司
版　　次：2026年6月第1版
印　　次：2026年6月第1次印刷
开　　本：787mm×1092mm　1/16
印　　张：9
字　　数：209千字
书　　号：ISBN 978-7-5193-1205-3
定　　价：128.00元

【版权所有，侵权必究】
如有缺页、倒页、脱页等印装质量问题，请拨打服务热线：010-62605166。

Contents

Introduction	4
Test 1	10
Test 2	32
Test 3	54
Test 4	75
Audioscripts	97
Listening and Reading answer keys	117
Sample Writing answers	125
Sample answer sheets	140
Acknowledgements	144

Introduction

Prepare for the exam with practice tests from Cambridge

Inside you'll find four authentic examination papers from Cambridge University Press & Assessment. They are the perfect way to practise – EXACTLY like the real exam.

Why are they unique?

All our authentic practice tests go through the same design process as the IELTS test. We check every single part of our practice tests with real students under exam conditions, to make sure we give you the most authentic experience possible.

Students can take these tests on their own or with the help of a teacher to familiarise themselves with the exam format, understand the scoring system and practise exam technique.

Further information

IELTS is jointly managed by the British Council, IDP: IELTS Australia and Cambridge University Press & Assessment. Further information can be found on the IELTS official website at ielts.org.

WHAT IS THE TEST FORMAT?

IELTS consists of four components. All candidates take the same Listening and Speaking tests. There is a choice of Reading and Writing tests according to whether a candidate is taking the Academic or General Training module.

Academic	**General Training**
For candidates wishing to study at undergraduate or postgraduate levels, and for those seeking professional registration.	For candidates wishing to migrate to an English-speaking country (Australia, Canada, New Zealand, UK) and for those wishing to train or study below degree level.

The test components are taken in the following order:

Listening 4 parts, 40 items, approximately 30 minutes		
Academic Reading 3 sections, 40 items 60 minutes	or	**General Training Reading** 3 sections, 40 items 60 minutes
Academic Writing 2 tasks 60 minutes	or	**General Training Writing** 2 tasks 60 minutes
Speaking 11 to 14 minutes		
Total (Maximum) Test Time 2 hours 44 minutes		

ACADEMIC TEST FORMAT

Listening

This test consists of four parts, each with ten questions. The first two parts are concerned with social needs. The first part is a conversation between two speakers and the second part is a monologue. The final two parts are concerned with situations related to educational or training contexts. The third part is a conversation between up to four people and the fourth part is a monologue.

A variety of question types is used, including: multiple choice, matching, plan/map/diagram labelling, form completion, note completion, table completion, flowchart completion, summary completion, sentence completion and short-answer questions.

Candidates hear the recording once only and answer the questions as they listen. Ten minutes are allowed at the end for candidates to transfer their answers to the answer sheet.

Reading

This test consists of three sections with 40 questions. There are three texts, which are taken from journals, books, magazines and newspapers. The texts are on topics of general interest. At least one text contains detailed logical argument.

A variety of question types is used, including: multiple choice, identifying information (True/False/Not Given), identifying the writer's views/claims (Yes/No/Not Given), matching information, matching headings, matching features, matching sentence endings, sentence completion, summary completion, note completion, table completion, flowchart completion, diagram-label completion and short-answer questions.

Writing

This test consists of two tasks. It is suggested that candidates spend about 20 minutes on Task 1, which requires them to write at least 150 words, and 40 minutes on Task 2, which requires them to write at least 250 words. Task 2 contributes twice as much as Task 1 to the Writing score.

Task 1 requires candidates to look at a diagram or some data (in a graph, table or chart) and to present the information in their own words. They are assessed on their ability to organise, present and possibly compare data, and are required to describe the stages of a process, describe an object or event, or explain how something works.

In Task 2, candidates are presented with a point of view, argument or problem. They are assessed on their ability to present a solution to the problem, present and justify an opinion, compare and contrast evidence and opinions, and evaluate and challenge ideas, evidence or arguments.

Candidates are also assessed on their ability to write in an appropriate style. More information on assessing the Writing test, including Writing assessment criteria (public version), is available at ielts.org.

Speaking

This test takes between 11 and 14 minutes and is conducted by a trained examiner. There are three parts:

Part 1

The candidate and the examiner introduce themselves. Candidates then answer general questions about themselves, their home/family, their job/studies, their interests and a wide range of similar familiar topic areas. This part lasts between four and five minutes.

Part 2

The candidate is given a task card with prompts and is asked to talk on a particular topic. The candidate has one minute to prepare and they can make some notes if they wish, before speaking for between one and two minutes. The examiner then asks one or two questions on the same topic.

Part 3

The examiner and the candidate engage in a discussion of more abstract issues which are thematically linked to the topic in Part 2. The discussion lasts between four and five minutes.

The Speaking test assesses whether candidates can communicate effectively in English. The assessment takes into account Fluency and Coherence, Lexical Resource, Grammatical Range and Accuracy, and Pronunciation. More information on assessing the Speaking test, including Speaking assessment criteria (public version), is available at ielts.org.

HOW IS IELTS SCORED?

IELTS results are reported on a nine-band scale. In addition to the score for overall language ability, IELTS provides a score in the form of a profile for each of the four skills (Listening, Reading, Writing and Speaking). These scores are also reported on a nine-band scale. All scores are recorded on the Test Report Form along with details of the candidate's nationality, first language and date of birth. Each Overall Band Score corresponds to a descriptive statement which gives a summary of the English-language ability of a candidate classified at that level. The nine bands and their descriptive statements are as follows:

9 ***Expert user*** *– Has fully operational command of the language: appropriate, accurate and fluent with complete understanding.*

8 ***Very good user*** *– Has fully operational command of the language with only occasional unsystematic inaccuracies and inappropriacies. Misunderstandings may occur in unfamiliar situations. Handles complex detailed argumentation well.*

7 ***Good user*** *– Has operational command of the language, though with occasional inaccuracies, inappropriacies and misunderstandings in some situations. Generally handles complex language well and understands detailed reasoning.*

6 ***Competent user*** *– Has generally effective command of the language despite some inaccuracies, inappropriacies and misunderstandings. Can use and understand fairly complex language, particularly in familiar situations.*

5 ***Modest user*** *– Has partial command of the language, coping with overall meaning in most situations, though is likely to make many mistakes. Should be able to handle basic communication in own field.*

4 ***Limited user*** *– Basic competence is limited to familiar situations. Has frequent problems in understanding and expression. Is not able to use complex language.*

3 ***Extremely limited user*** *– Conveys and understands only general meaning in very familiar situations. Frequent breakdowns in communication occur.*

2 ***Intermittent user*** *– Has great difficulty understanding spoken and written English.*

1 ***Non-user*** *– Essentially has no ability to use the language beyond possibly a few isolated words.*

0 ***Did not attempt the test*** *– Did not answer the questions.*

MARKING THE PRACTICE TESTS

Listening and Reading

The answer keys are on pages 117–124.
Each question in the Listening and Reading tests is worth one mark.

Questions which require letter / Roman numeral answers

For questions where the answers are letters or Roman numerals, you should write *only* the number of answers required. For example, if the answer is a single letter or numeral, you should write only one answer. If you have written more letters or numerals than are required, the answer must be marked wrong.

Questions which require answers in the form of words or numbers

- Answers may be written in upper or lower case.
- Words in brackets are *optional* – they are correct, but not necessary.
- Alternative answers are separated by a slash (/).
- If you are asked to write an answer using a certain number of words and/or (a) number(s), you will be penalised if you exceed this. For example, if a question specifies an answer using NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS and the correct answer is 'black leather coat', the answer 'coat of black leather' is *incorrect*.
- In questions where you are expected to complete a gap, you should only transfer the necessary missing word(s) onto the answer sheet. For example, to complete 'in the . . .', where the correct answer is 'morning', the answer 'in the morning' would be *incorrect*.
- All answers require correct spelling (including words in brackets).
- Both US and UK spelling are acceptable and are included in the answer key.
- All standard alternatives for numbers, dates and currencies are acceptable.
- All standard abbreviations are acceptable.
- You will find additional notes about individual answers in the answer key.

Writing

The sample answers are on pages 125–139. It is not possible for you to give yourself a mark for the Writing tasks. We have provided sample answers (written by candidates), showing their score and the examiners' comments. Additional sample and model answers can be downloaded from the Resource Bank. These sample and model answers will give you an insight into what is required for the Writing test.

HOW SHOULD YOU INTERPRET YOUR SCORES?

At the end of each Listening and Reading answer key you will find a chart which will help you assess whether, on the basis of your practice test results, you are ready to take the IELTS test.

In interpreting your score, there are a number of points you should bear in mind. Your performance in the real IELTS test will be reported in two ways: there will be a Band Score from 1 to 9 for each of the components and an Overall Band Score from 1 to 9, which is the average of your scores in the four components. However, institutions considering your application are advised to look at both the Overall Band Score and the Band Score for each component in order to determine whether you have the language skills needed for a particular course of study. For example, if your course involves a lot of reading and writing, but no lectures, listening skills might be less important and a score of 5 in Listening might be acceptable if the Overall Band Score was 7. However, for a course which has lots of lectures and spoken instructions, a score of 5 in Listening might be unacceptable even though the Overall Band Score was 7.

Once you have marked your tests, you should have some idea of whether your listening and reading skills are good enough for you to try the IELTS test. If you did well enough in one component, but not in others, you will have to decide for yourself whether you are ready to take the test.

The practice tests have been checked to ensure that they are the same level of difficulty as the real IELTS test. However, we cannot guarantee that your score in the practice tests will be reflected in the real IELTS test. The practice tests can only give you an idea of your possible future performance and it is ultimately up to you to make decisions based on your score.

Different institutions accept different IELTS scores for different types of courses. We have based our recommendations on the average scores which the majority of institutions accept. The institution to which you are applying may, of course, require a higher or lower score than most other institutions.

Test 1

LISTENING

PART 1 *Questions 1–10*

Questions 1–6

Complete the table below.

Write **ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER** for each answer.

Oyster Bay Sailing Club Courses

Name of course	What you learn	Cost	Other information
Taster day	introduction to sailing	£120 if booking one place	small groups (max **1** ..... people)
Level 1	basic theory e.g. understanding the **2** ..... and tides basic sailing skills including **3** ..... information	£200 **4** ..... available for club members all inclusive (plus a useful **5** .....)	a **6** ..... at the end of the course for all participants

Questions 7–10

Complete the notes below.

*Write **ONE WORD ONLY** for each answer.*

General information
• Participants must be able to swim.
• Bring suitable clothing, a **7** ..... and toiletries (e.g. shampoo).
• There is a **8** ..... at the club.
• Online training **9** ..... are recommended.
• **10** ..... are available for course participants.

PART 2 *Questions 11–20*

Questions 11–16

*Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B** or **C**.*

Working as a makeup trainee

11 What should trainees always expect to get when working on low budget short films?

A travel expenses
B a minimum wage
C meals

12 According to the speaker, on big budget films trainees may get experience of

A makeup for special effects.
B working with different ethnicities.
C creating a variety of hair styles.

13 The speaker says a problem for makeup artists is

A dealing with difficult directors.
B being shouted at by their supervisor.
C waiting around for hours doing nothing.

14 How did the speaker feel when she met famous actors for the first time?

A very shy
B very proud
C very disappointed

15 What advice does the speaker give about makeup kits?

A Always carry a basic kit with you.
B Only buy the best products for a makeup kit.
C Ask other makeup artists to check your kit.

16 What advice does the speaker give about creating a portfolio?

A Keep print and digital photos.
B Only include a small selection of photos.
C Get permission to use photos.

Test 1

Questions 17–20

What ability is required for each of the following duties?

*Write the correct letter, **A**, **B**, or **C**, next to Questions 17–20.*

A	being well-organised
B	being flexible
C	working quickly

Duties

17 Prepping an actor .....

18 Continuity .....

19 General .....

20 Applying makeup .....

PART 3 *Questions 21–30*

Questions 21 and 22

*Choose **TWO** letters, **A–E**.*

Which **TWO** features of the lecture on ocean biodiversity had the greatest impact on the students?

A the references to local problems
B the broad focus of the examples
C the practical suggestions for solutions
D the type of issues discussed
E the implications for government policy

Questions 23 and 24

*Choose **TWO** letters, **A–E**.*

Which **TWO** details about the research project particularly impressed the students?

A the team's previous successes
B its wide geographical scale
C the use of new technology
D the extensive statistical evidence
E the large range of specialists involved

Questions 25–30

What is the students' opinion of each of the following resources related to ocean biodiversity?

*Choose **SIX** answers from the box and write the correct letter, **A–H**, next to Questions 25–30.*

	Opinions
A	This is aimed at a very specialist audience.
B	This is now rather outdated.
C	This was an effective description of a new danger.
D	This suggests possible ways to improve the situation.
E	This does not give a balanced account.
F	This is too predictable to be useful.
G	This gives insufficient evidence for its claims.
H	This gives a clear explanation of the problems.

Resources

25 Article on invasive lionfish .....

26 Documentary on microplastics .....

27 Podcast on ocean pollution .....

28 Book on coastal ecosystems .....

29 Article on metal toxicity .....

30 Podcast on floating marine cities .....

PART 4 *Questions 31–40*

Complete the notes below.

*Write **ONE WORD ONLY** for each answer.*

Sources of rubber

Three resources which are essential for industrial civilisation

- **31** .....
- fossil fuels
- rubber

Natural rubber

This mainly comes from the Pará rubber tree, now cultivated in South-East Asia.
The supply is limited because

- the growth of the tree is **32** .....
- production cannot easily be adjusted because of increasing or decreasing **33** .....
- the tree only grows near the **34** .....
- extracting the latex (rubber) is labour-intensive
- it is very difficult to **35** ..... rubber after production.

New threats include

- lack of genetic diversity, leading to danger of disease caused by a **36** .....
- a shift to the cultivation of palm oil
- extreme **37** ..... events.

Synthetic rubber

- may be used for engine parts and cooking utensils
- is less **38** ..... than natural rubber
- is unsuitable for many purposes e.g. the tyres of aircraft.

An alternative source of natural rubber

- A wild flower (a type of dandelion) has rubber in its **39** ..... .
- It can be grown in many locations and does not require good **40** ..... .

→ p. 117 p. 101

READING

READING PASSAGE 1

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 1–13**, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.*

The Davies Sisters

Between 1908 and 1924, Gwendoline and Margaret Davies amassed one of the largest collections of late-nineteenth and early-twentieth-century French paintings in Britain

Gwendoline (1882–1951) and Margaret (1884–1963) Davies were the granddaughters of David Davies, a Welshman who amassed a fortune in the shipping and mining industries. In 1907, when Gwendoline came into her inheritance (Margaret would follow in 1909), the sisters were said to be the wealthiest unmarried women in Britain. Their religious upbringing in rural Wales gave them a deep sense of social responsibility and they chose to use their inheritance for cultural and philanthropic* purposes.

While there was no real family history of art collecting, the sisters' education was rigorously geared toward such pursuits. Their London school focused on cultural rather than academic study, and they travelled extensively with their governess, Jane Blaker, visiting art galleries and making extensive notes on the collections there.

The sisters began to make regular art purchases from 1908, which roughly coincided with the dates of their inheritance. They took advice from various people, including the art dealer Hugh Blaker (the brother of Jane Blaker) and David Croal Thompson, who was also an art dealer. While it was long assumed that these men were largely responsible for the nature of the sisters' collection, it has recently been accepted that Gwendoline and Margaret retained a far more active role in the process.

The sisters' journals reveal their preference for Old Master** paintings. Yet they initially made very few attempts to secure any such works. While the sisters were wealthy in relative terms, their income was nothing compared to the fortunes of American art collectors of this period, such as J. Pierpont Morgan. Quite simply, high quality Old Master works were, if not beyond their means, then beyond what they were willing to pay for them. Instead, their early purchases were of the fashionable, safe variety, and included, for example, paintings by the French artist Jean-Baptiste-Camille Corot.

---

* philanthropic: seeking to promote the welfare of others, often by charitable funding

** Old Master: a highly respected artist of great skill who worked in Europe before about 1800

However, it was only a few years before their collecting took a new direction and they turned to the work of the French Impressionists***. We know that Hugh Blaker, as a champion of contemporary French art had a hand in the decision, and we know also that they would have seen examples on their various trips to Paris. Whatever the precise reason for this change, their first purchases of Impressionist art, made in October 1912, were scenes of Venice by the French artist Claude Monet. Over the next 12 years, the sisters amassed the bulk of their Impressionist collection, including six further works by Monet, two more by Manet, and three by Renoir, including his well-known painting La Parisienne.

The First World War (1914-1918) played a part in the development of the sisters' collection. Their initial response to the war effort was to finance the safe passage of artists from occupied Belgium to Wales, as a humanitarian act, but also with the hope of establishing a vibrant artists' community in the area. Later in the conflict, both sisters decided to volunteer at a canteen for troops at Troyes, in northern France; Gwendoline in 1916, followed by Margaret in 1917.

It was tedious and distressing work, which would have a permanent effect on Gwendoline's health. Yet on one of numerous trips to nearby Paris, she visited the Bernheim-Jeune Gallery. Here she acquired two works by Cézanne – Provençal Landscape and The François Zola Dam. The paintings were shipped directly to Bath, England, where they became the first works by Cézanne to go on display in a public gallery in Britain.

Commentators have often described the sisters as unlikely pioneer collectors. Much is made of their isolation in rural Wales and the fact that they didn't make friends with artists or gallery owners. Yet they didn't feel obliged to follow fashionable tastes and were free to pursue their own preferences. Although they relied on a trusted circle of advisers, they made frequent trips to London and Paris, and also regularly had paintings sent to their home for consideration.

By the early 1920s, Gwendoline felt increasingly uncomfortable buying art works when faced with the poverty and social upheaval created by the First World War. Her philanthropic pursuits then became focused almost exclusively on social causes and the development of the sisters' home at Gregynog Hall into a conference center and venue for the Gregynog Festival of Music and Poetry. Gwendoline made her final art purchase in March 1926. Margaret also stopped collecting around this time, but started again in the 1930s acquiring, on a relatively small scale, work by contemporary British artists.

The sisters collected French Impressionist paintings at a time when such art was routinely ignored by individuals and institutions alike. The Gwendoline and Margaret Davies collection, donated in 1951 and 1963 respectively to the National Museum Wales, contains major examples of work by leading French Impressionists. In collecting paintings that they loved, the sisters created a lasting and meaningful cultural legacy for the people of Wales and beyond.

*** Impressionist: an artist with a style of painting that developed in France in the late 1800s by Renoir, including his well-known painting La Parisienne

Test 1

Questions 1–7

Complete the notes below.

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 1–7 on your answer sheet.

Gwendoline and Margaret Davies

Family and early life

- their grandfather's wealth came from **1** ..... and transportation businesses
- their upbringing gave them a sense of social responsibility
- their **2** ..... was designed to give them an interest in activities such as collecting art
- their governess took them on trips to art galleries
- they took lengthy **3** ..... about the things they saw in art galleries

The sisters as art collectors

- their **4** ..... showed they liked Old Master paintings, but they were expensive to buy
- their early purchases were safe, popular paintings
- the first Impressionist paintings they bought showed places in **5** .....

Impact of First World War

- they helped bring artists from Belgium to Wales
- they worked in a **6** ..... for soldiers in France

Opinions about the sisters as art collectors

- were not considered typical collectors – they lived in isolation in the countryside and did not have any **7** ..... who were artists

Questions 8–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

In boxes 8–13 on your answer sheet, write

TRUE	*if the statement agrees with the information*
FALSE	*if the statement contradicts the information*
NOT GIVEN	*if there is no information on this*

8 The Davies sisters' childhood influenced the way they decided to use their wealth.

9 The Jean-Baptiste-Camille Corot paintings in the Davies sisters' collection were purchased from a gallery in France.

10 Hugh Blaker opposed the Davies sisters' decision to buy art by French Impressionists.

11 The exhibition of Cézanne paintings at the Bath gallery was very popular with the public.

12 The impact of the First World War encouraged Gwendoline to reconsider her interest in collecting art.

13 The Davies sisters bought French Impressionist art during a period when very few people were doing so.

→ p. 118

READING PASSAGE 2

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 14–26**, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.*

Why we need silence

A Humans are finely attuned to noise, and for good reason. From an evolutionary perspective, sounds give us vital information, helping us navigate the world and avoid danger. To help ensure loud or unexpected noises get the attention they deserve, our internal chemistry alters in response to them. Our blood pressure goes up, muscles tense and glands release hormones that prepare us for fight or flight. In the short term, this is a good thing. When we are exposed to too much noise over the long term, however, those responses can lead to a multitude of health issues, from sleep disturbance to even cardiovascular disease.

B The World Health Organization has recently designated excessive noise as an 'underestimated threat' to public health, and has said that people living in cities such as Mumbai, Tokyo and Buenos Aires are being exposed to far more than the recommended 40 decibels of noise at night. A report from the European Environment Agency concluded that noise was an ongoing and widespread issue in Europe, with at least 1 in 5 people consistently exposed to levels considered harmful to health. 'There are no "earlids" that can protect your brain from noise,' says Nick Antonio, an acoustic consultant who has contributed to the British and international standards for noise.

C The good news is that several cities have been working to turn the volume down. One of the first to do so was London. 'By providing recommendations for quieter buses, reducing noise from roads and also controlling noise from aircraft, they were able to make the city quieter,' says Antonio. Other cities have introduced noise-reducing road coatings, for instance, alongside greenery that muffles sound. Some solutions are more specific: Washington DC's ban on petrol-powered leaf blowers came into effect recently, while in New York City, legislation has been approved to fine people who modify their vehicles to make them noisier. 'People are seeing the benefits of these more quiet environments in their cities,' Antonio says. 'I expect we will see much more of this in the future.'

D Researchers are also seeking to understand what aspects of silent experiences are most beneficial to our health. One of the best-researched is the flotation tank: a lightproof, soundproof tank of salt water in which a person floats as a form of deep relaxation. While some people experience altered perception in the tanks, involving subtle humming sounds and visual effects, these effects are benign and do not detract from the benefits of the experience, says Justin Feinstein, a clinical neuropsychologist. 'When you don't have external sensory stimuli coming in, the brain tries to fill the void to make sense of this dark and silent world,' he explains. 'In these tanks, some people can even hear the sound of their eyes blinking,' says Feinstein. 'But it is the ability to focus on the breath that helps people reach a relaxed or meditative state.'

E To further explore flotation tanks as a therapeutic tool, Feinstein and his colleagues recruited 50 people with a variety of conditions related to stress and had them answer a questionnaire prior to and following a flotation session. Participants reported decreases in muscle tension, pain and symptoms of their conditions after a single, 1-hour float, alongside an increase in feelings of relaxation and overall wellbeing.

Less is known about what effects sensory deprivation can have on the brain. To investigate, Feinstein's team had 48 people participate in either three 90-minute float sessions or three 90-minute periods of relaxing on a chair which reclined. Participants had their brains scanned using functional magnetic resonance imaging at the beginning and end of the trial. Float sessions uniquely decreased activity in the default mode network (DMN), a collection of brain regions commonly linked with depression. Feinstein says it is an exciting finding, because flotation tanks seem to offer a way of 'resetting' our nervous system to prevent it from getting out of balance.

F Neurobiologist Tal Dotan Ben-Soussan is also an advocate of silence as a therapy. 'When we find ways to be quiet, we are not only quiet in our environment, but quiet in our inner selves,' she explains. 'This allows us to be more aware of what is happening around us and what the situation may require from us so we can provide [a more] adequate response.'

Not everyone will benefit from silence to the same extent, but Ben-Soussan says one characteristic is key: the person must need to want to engage in the experience. 'We see from animal models and human studies that volition and intentionality is important,' she says. 'When people do not want silence, it can be very distressing.'

G Eric Pfeifer, a psychotherapy researcher, also concedes that some people may not benefit from silence, particularly those who are in a heightened state of stress. 'People in these states may not be able to relax or calm down in a silent condition,' he says. Professional guidance can be useful, he adds, allowing people to approach silence slowly so that they can gradually enjoy the benefits. And Pfeifer is convinced that silence is more attainable in everyday life than people think. First, complete silence isn't necessary. In a recent study, he found that participants reported more relaxation and less boredom when they sat quietly in an outdoor garden compared with a completely silent room. Second, Pfeifer believes we don't need a lot of silence to gain benefits. 'You don't need to spend hours in silence,' he says. 'It is likely better to have more frequency of silence for a few minutes at a time than a longer period of silence only once a week. Just finding those places in your daily life where you can find some silence … can make a big difference.'

Questions 14–17

Reading Passage 2 has seven sections, **A–G**.

Which section contains the following information?

*Write the correct letter, **A–G**, in boxes 14–17 on your answer sheet.*

14 examples of strategies to decrease the noise that the public are exposed to

15 data indicating the extent of the problem of excessive noise

16 a description of physiological changes in our bodies when we hear sudden noises

17 evidence that a relatively quiet environment can be more beneficial than a totally silent one

Questions 18–21

Complete the summary below.

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 18–21 on your answer sheet.

Flotation Tanks

According to Justin Feinstein, flotation tanks allow people to concentrate on their own **18** ..... , which helps them relax and enables them to meditate.

Feinstein and his colleagues conducted an experiment in which 50 people, who were all suffering from stress and related issues, were given a **19** ..... to complete before and after using a flotation tank. Participants reported a reduction in their symptoms after an hour in the tank, together with signs of relaxation and improved general **20** ..... .

In another experiment, the researchers had 48 people spend periods of 90 minutes either lying back in a chair or floating in a tank. Brain scans then revealed that those people who had been in a tank had decreased activity in parts of the brain associated with **21** ..... .

Test 1

Questions 22–26

Look at the following statements (Questions 22–26) and the list of people below.

Match each statement with the correct person, ***A****,* ***B****,* ***C*** *or* ***D****.*

Write the correct letter, ***A****,* ***B****,* ***C*** *or* ***D****, in boxes 22–26 on your answer sheet.*

NB *You may use any letter more than once.*

22 It is unpleasant and upsetting for people to be placed in a silent environment against their will.

23 The trend towards creating quieter urban locations is likely to increase in the coming years.

24 When our body's senses are completely deprived of input, our minds compensate for this by creating the illusion of images and sounds.

25 Even a short amount of silent time can have a positive impact.

26 External and internal quietness makes us more conscious of events occurring in our surroundings and helps us react appropriately to these events.

List of People

A Nick Antonio

B Justin Feinstein

C Tal Dotan Ben-Soussan

D Eric Pfeifer

→ p. 118

READING PASSAGE 3

You should spend about 20 minutes on ***Questions 27–40****, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

Book review: *The World of Sugar* by Ulbe Bosma

Ulbe Bosma's *The World of Sugar* is a genuinely global history. Bosma discusses all the sugar-growing places of the world, beginning with Cuba and Java, the largest exporters of the early 20th century. But this is a history not just of cane sugar but also of beet sugar, an equally important form of traded sugar over the last hundred years. Beet sugar is grown mainly in Europe and the United States. It has also been massively subsidised and sold at artificially low prices on world markets, threatening the livelihood of producers of cane sugar.

Bosma's discussion of the sugar market in Britain gives a sense of the book's range. The sweet-toothed British first bought cane sugar from their own slavery-dependent colonial plantations. Following the abolition of slavery in the British Empire, cane sugar was imported to Britain from places which retained the practice, such as Cuba and Brazil. Towards the end of the 19th century, the British started to import beet sugar from continental Europe. Only in the 20th century was there a move to develop a national beet sugar industry.

The book provides a global labour history, investigating the wide range of labour regimes associated with growing sugar. Contrary to popular belief, cane sugar production was never just restricted to large, dedicated plantations owned by rich men. For example, in Java, a huge exporter of sugar in the early 20th century, sugar cane was grown together with rice in an extraordinarily labour-intensive way by small farmers.

The World of Sugar is also a story of similarity and continuity in sugar cultivation. For example, imported labour has been used for much large-scale production. German beet fields employed Polish workers; Mexicans and many others, including Sicilians, were vital to US sugar production. Cane cutting, Bosma shows, remains a poorly paid and brutal business to this day in many places in the world. But as well as this, the book is about the continuity of the use of traditional methods on small farms. In the mid 20th-century, this type of sugar production dominated in South Asia and Latin America.

This is also a history of capitalists and sugar dynasties, as well as corporations that in some cases have remained influential over very long periods. Great firms and great interests have had profound influence on the policies of states. In many places – not just the British Caribbean but Cuba and the Philippines too – a powerful sugar bourgeoisie played a major role in politics and their interests were consequently protected by trade barriers and subsidies. In the battle for control of the industry, it was inevitably the poor countries which came off worse. All this is explored by Bosma with wonderful subtlety and control.

Test 1

But sugar production was never just a matter of agriculture. It also involved the extraction, close to the place of harvest, of sucrose from the sugar plant, a process which required machinery powered by humans, animals, wind or steam. Further processes involved boiling (from the 19th century, this often involved vacuum systems) and the separation of sugar from other materials in a process known as refinement. From very early on, sugar production was an energy-intensive industrial process, mostly taking place in the countryside and in refineries in centres of consumption, both small and large. The growth of the industry entailed a very rapid diffusion of ideas and techniques from one country to another. Cuba, for example, developed an extraordinarily dense system of railways to transport workers and cane, as well as steam-powered sugar factories. Particular varieties of cane sugar and beet sugar spread very rapidly across the world, in accordance with local needs and demands.

Where once only tiny quantities of sugar could be produced, now new techniques, varieties, fertilisers, irrigation systems and much more have turned gleaming white sugar into a ubiquitous chemical. Over the same time, there has been a massive increase in consumption. Once regarded as a luxury, sugar came to be promoted as a valuable source of energy. But as the consumption of sugar has increased, so has the harm it does, whether to people's teeth or weight. In the face of appalling obstruction from the sugar industry to attempts to reduce consumption, some countries have been forced to tax sugar in order to bring that about. The sugar industry has a history of attacking its critics and, when it comes to obesity, of trying to blame fats, and lack of exercise and self-control. And the recent past has seen worrying new developments in mass sweetening. High-fructose corn syrup made from maize using an enzymatic process invented in Japan in the 1960s has a similar number of calories to table sugar but is far cheaper to produce. It is now widely consumed, having been adopted in the making of soft drinks and a large number of processed foods, and is regarded as a leading cause of obesity.

This is a wonderfully rich book, a model of global history, the history of production and the history of capitalism. Bosma avoids outbursts of emotion, celebratory or critical, even if they might have made his analysis of the multiple tragedies involving sugar all the more powerful. He shows that we could always have done without sugar and that today we have many alternative sources of sweetness. Yet many of the poorest people in the world still depend on it to make a living.

Questions 27–30

Choose the correct letter, ***A****,* ***B****,* ***C*** *or* ***D****.*

Write the correct letter in boxes 27–30 on your answer sheet.

27 What does the reviewer suggest about the cultivation and trading of sugar in the first paragraph?

A Sugar has played a major role in international relations.
B Beet sugar has been made more internationally competitive.
C Cane sugar is thought to be of superior quality to beet sugar.
D New locations for cultivating sugar have increased production.

28 In the second paragraph, when discussing the sugar market in Britain, the reviewer stresses

A how the sources used changed over time.
B how developments in agriculture affected trade.
C the increased demand for sugar over the years.
D the growing support for ethical methods of cultivation.

29 What is the reviewer doing in the third paragraph?

A describing an efficient approach to sugar cultivation
B explaining why the use of sugar plantations declined
C addressing a misconception about the growing of sugar cane
D evaluating different approaches to the cultivation of sugar cane

30 In the final paragraph, what does the reviewer suggest is the overall message of Bosma's book?

A Sugar is a harmful and unnecessary product.
B Economic pressure is needed to control sugar production.
C Conditions for workers in sugar production should be improved.
D Intensive marketing of sugar has had disastrous consequences.

Questions 31–36

*Complete the summary using the list of words, **A–I**, below.*

*Write the correct letter, **A–I**, in boxes 31–36 on your answer sheet.*

Sugar cultivation and production

The book *The World of Sugar* points out the similarities in the way that sugar was cultivated around the world. In the big industries in both Germany and the US, sugar farming depended on **31** ..... . However, in other parts of the world such as South Asia and Latin America, **32** ..... continued.

Sugar production has also involved **33** ..... who were eager to protect their markets. In countries such as Cuba the sugar industry therefore had a major influence on **34** ..... .

To support the interests of sugar producers, **35** ..... were established. As a result of this, **36** ..... were penalised.

A	national governments	**B**	agricultural developments	**C**	less wealthy nations
D	untrained workers	**E**	small-scale cultivation	**F**	outdated methods
G	financial controls	**H**	migrant workers	**I**	powerful individuals and businesses

Questions 37–40

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 37–40 on your answer sheet, write

YES	*if the statement agrees with the views of the writer*
NO	*if the statement contradicts the views of the writer*
NOT GIVEN	*if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

37 Sugar has now become available in large quantities due to a range of agricultural developments.

38 Advertisers initially marketed sugar as a luxury product.

39 The invention of high-fructose corn syrup was a positive development.

40 High-fructose corn syrup is an ingredient in many processed foods.

→ p. 118

WRITING

WRITING TASK 1

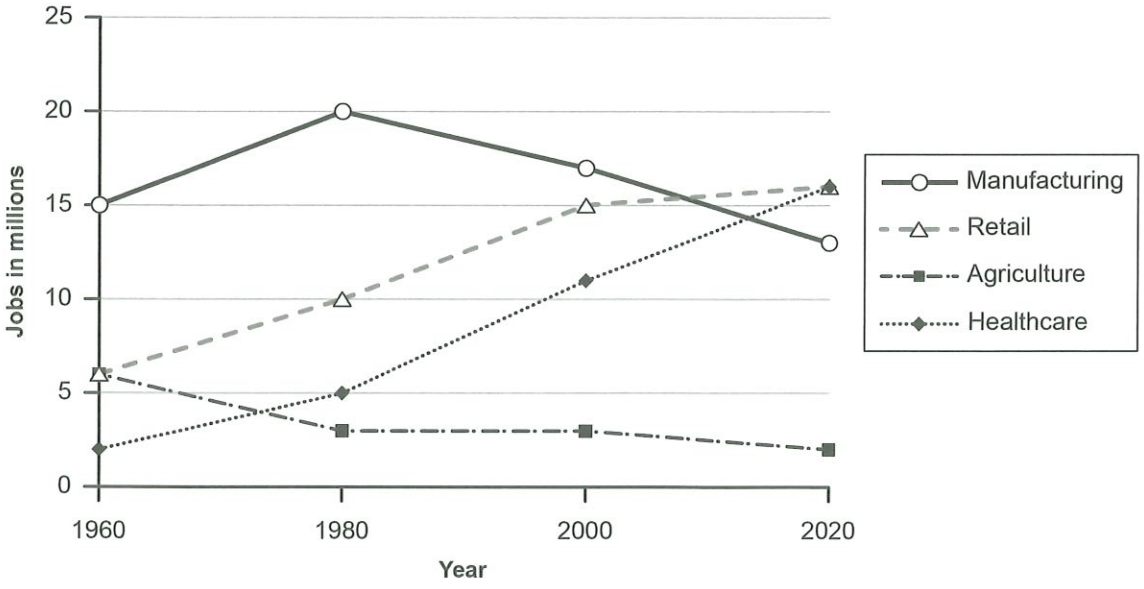
You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

The graph below gives information about the number of jobs in four sectors of the economy in the US between 1960 and 2020.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

Write at least 150 words.

Number of jobs in four sectors of the economy in the US, 1960-2020



→ p. 125

WRITING TASK 2

You should spend about 40 minutes on this task.

Write about the following topic:

> ***The best way to provide enough homes in large cities is to build tall apartment blocks.***
>
> ***To what extent do you agree or disagree with this statement?***

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

Write at least 250 words.

→ p. 127

SPEAKING

PART 1

The examiner asks you about yourself, your home, work or studies and other familiar topics.

EXAMPLE

Hairstyles

- Where do you go to get a haircut?
- Have you changed your hairstyle recently?
- Would you ever change the colour of your hair?
- Do you enjoy going to the hairdresser/barber?

PART 2

Describe a time when you used information for tourists, for example from a guidebook or online.

You should say:
where you got this information
what place this information was about
what information you got

and explain whether this information was very helpful for you.

You will have to talk about the topic for 1 to 2 minutes. You have 1 minute to think about what you are going to say. You can make some notes to help you if you wish.

PART 3

Discussion topics:

Different types of holidays

Example questions:
What are the most popular kinds of holidays for people from your country to go on?
Do you think most people prefer to have a holiday abroad rather than in their own country?
Why do some people want to do absolutely nothing when they go away on holiday?

Tourist attractions

Example questions:
What are the kinds of tourist attraction that visitors to your country like to see?
Do you think tourist attractions such as museums should be free for local people to visit?
What can make a tourist attraction disappointing for visitors?